

Skeletons

Dinosaur skeletons could support enormous bodies, providing a strong and stable frame. These bony structures also protected the vital organs like the heart and lungs. Fossilized skeletons show us how dinosaurs might have looked and moved.

Window in the skull, called a fenestra, made the skeleton lighter.

Albertosaurus skeleton

This big, scary predator was a fast mover, especially when hunting prey. The skeleton shows a body built for speed, with two strong back legs. Albertosaurus could grow to 30 ft (9 m) long.

The eye sockets faced slightly forward, which helped when judging the distance to a prey animal!

The large jaws would have had powerful muscles attached to them for a strong bite.

The gastralia were extra ribs that may have helped with breathing.

Claws

Dinosaur claws could be used to attack prey or defend against predators. Hungry meat-eaters stabbed their victims with sharp claws, while threatened plant-eaters wounded attackers with claws just as deadly.

Killer claw

The meat-eating Velociraptor had an enormous curved claw on each foot, used to rip open prey.

